

work with, and Monitor profiles tell your OS how to display colours on the monitor.

Why do I need to know this?

By using colour space profiles, you are ensuring that your image will appear the same irrespective of what monitor it is viewed on or what printer it is printed on—you'll never have to tinker with colour correction once you've set a profile.

11.2 Getting Consistent Colour

Enough *gyan*; let's set up our machines for consistent colour to prevent any colour-related woes in the future.

Stage I: The Monitor

Calibrating your monitor is the most important step in colour management. After all, it's where you will be seeing your work the most.



Adobe Gamma

When you install Photoshop, it also installs a Control Panel tool called Adobe Gamma, which will help you calibrate your monitor. It isn't what you would use if you were a graphics professional—there is highly specialised hardware and software for that—but for the average user, Adobe Gamma is quite adequate.

You need to keep a few things in mind before you go through Adobe Gamma's setup procedure:

- Make sure your monitor has been on for about a half hour or so. You need to let the CRT warm up to a point where it displays consistent results.